

placed at strategic points between text. The difference here is that advertisements could be animated, and perhaps even supported by sound—sort of like the Flash advertisements you come across online!

If connectivity improves, you could perhaps use the (imaginary/future) WiMax public network to avail of a special offer that was advertised! Of course, we're getting ahead of ourselves here... or are we?

Let's take a look at a few ways rollable paper displays have started to revolutionise a few areas of everyday life. Expect to see a lot more of these examples in the near future!

Seiko's "Future Now" E-Paper Display Watch

This watch looks like a stylish wristband, and is incredibly slim and sleek. The watch's display is made up entirely of a paper display, and offers, as usual, a high-contrast screen.



Seiko's watch displays the time using a paper display. The flexibility of the paper display allows for some innovative designs

Since the display has pure black and pure white particles, it offers almost the same readability as printed paper, and about twice the contrast of an LCD screen. Since the display is flexible, it helps Seiko use only curves in the design, which is why the watch looks so sexy! This also opens up a whole new world of outlets for the creative juices of watch designers: they can now achieve designs that were not possible earlier, due to the inflexible nature of previous faces and displays.

Because the paper display is so small, and is a simple implementation, it has virtually no power consumption, at least when compared with any other existing display technologies. You can hope to see the "Future Now" watch to hit stores somewhere in mid-2006, since release dates have been set for spring 2006 for Japan.

Colour?

So far, we've only seen products that offer monochrome displays, as those were easier to produce. However, this does not mean that colour displays were ruled out. Till date, all the aforementioned products and technologies

were flexible monochrome displays. So, when E-Ink's technology was recently used to produce colour paper displays, it resulted in a great deal of excitement. However, E-Ink is still working on making these displays flexible or rollable.

Let's look at a few products that have been made using this colour paper display technology:

Microsoft Xbox's Point-Of-Purchase Jade Empire Game Release

Yes, we realise it's a mouthful, but that's what it's called! A Point-Of-Purchase (POP) promotion is basically an advertising or promotional gimmick that's undertaken in stores (the points of purchase) to attract customers to a particular product.

Those of you into Pink Floyd might remember that their album *Pulse* utilised a revolutionary method of attracting attention—the Laser Disc of the album had a red LED on the box that would blink "Pulse" every couple of seconds. This actually increased sales!

Neolux Corporation, a leader in the field of POP promotions, devised a plan which could use E-Ink's paper display technology to create a revolutionary POP promotional method called the "Ink-In-Motion". Basically, they could use paper displays to attractively animate the packaging of a product!

Apparently, someone at Microsoft thought this was perfect for the launch of the new Xbox game *Jade Empire*. Shown here are three images, one with all displays off, the second is the next step in the animation and the third is an even more enhanced animation. You can also see the GIF file at: www.eink.com/press/images/image_release_82.html/ to get a better idea of how the animation appears.

Considering all this was done, affordably, using paper displays, you can well imagine how stores are going to look in the future. Perhaps low-cost products may not employ such tactics, but game distributors are surely going to be looking into this technology.

As the paper displays improve, we may even be able to preview actual screenshots from games before buying them. Or even turn the box over and read reviews of the game, from our choicest Web sites, which can be downloaded off the Net! The possibilities are well and truly limitless!



It's impossible to show you animation in *Digit*... yet! Somewhere down the line, perhaps, even we can use paper displays the way Microsoft did—to help draw attention to their new Xbox release. Notice the changing colours!